

15 BEST THINGS TO DO IN GDYNIA

A Comprehensive Guide to the Coastal City's Top Attractions

1. SKWER KOSCIUSZKI

Serving as the vibrant heart of the city, this representative promenade leads directly to the waterfront. It is lined with lively cafes, restaurants, and street food stalls. During the summer, it becomes the center of festivals and concerts, making it the perfect starting point for any visit to Gdynia.

2. DAR POMORZA

Known as the "White Frigate," this stunning full-rigged sailing ship was built in 1909 and bought by the people of Pomerania in 1929. It served as a training ship for the Polish Merchant Navy for decades. Today, it functions as a museum where you can explore the engine room, crew quarters, and historical navigational instruments.

3. ORP BLYSKAWICA

Moored right next to Dar Pomorza, this is the oldest preserved destroyer in the world of its class. It served with distinction in World War II, taking part in the Norwegian Campaign and the evacuation of Dunkirk. Visitors can step aboard to see its impressive anti-aircraft guns, torpedo tubes, and naval exhibitions below deck.

4. GDYNIA AQUARIUM

Located at the very end of the southern pier, the aquarium houses over 1,500 marine animals from around the world. Exhibits include colorful coral reefs, dangerous Amazonian piranhas, and local Baltic Sea fauna. It is an excellent educational stop, especially for families traveling with children.

5. KAMIENNA GORA

Rising 52 meters above sea level, this scenic viewpoint offers the best panoramic vistas of Gdynia's harbor, the Baltic Sea, and even the Hel Peninsula on clear days. You can hike up through a beautiful park or take the free, modern funicular railway to the top, where a large illuminated cross stands.

6. ORLOWO PIER

Dating back to World War I, this 180-meter-long wooden pier is a quieter, more romantic alternative to the famous Sopot pier. It provides a peaceful atmosphere for relaxing strolls and is renowned for being one of the best spots on the Polish coast to watch the sunrise over the water.

7. ORLOWO CLIFF

A dramatic and constantly eroding coastal cliff that creates one of the most photogenic landscapes in northern Poland. Walking along the beach below the sheer sandy drops is spectacular, while the forest trails of the Kepa Redlowska nature reserve above offer excellent hiking opportunities.

8. EMIGRATION MUSEUM

Housed in the historic Marine Station from 1933, this is the very building from which thousands of Poles departed for the Americas. The modern, highly interactive museum tells the deeply moving stories of Polish emigrants over the centuries, exploring the economic and political reasons behind their journeys.

9. GDYNIA CITY MUSEUM

This modern museum explores the miraculous transformation of Gdynia from a small fishing village into a major international port in just a decade during the 1920s. It places a heavy emphasis on the unique modernist architecture—the "White City"—that defines Gdynia's urban layout today.

10. NAVAL MUSEUM

Located right by the city beach, this museum features an extensive outdoor exhibition of naval weaponry, including torpedoes, sea mines, cannons, and military helicopters. Inside, detailed exhibits chronicle the history of the Polish Navy, its Baltic operations, and naval uniforms through the ages.

11. EXPERYMENT SCIENCE CENTRE

An incredibly popular, hands-on science and technology museum. It is divided into interactive zones such as "Hydro-world" (water physics) and "Human Body" (biology). Visitors of all ages are encouraged to touch, play, and conduct their own physical experiments in a fun, engaging environment.

12. MARINA GDYNIA

As the sailing capital of Poland, this expansive marina is home to luxurious yachts and sailboats from all over Europe. It frequently hosts international sailing regattas. The area around the marina is lined with some of the city's best seafood restaurants and trendy cocktail bars.

13. BULWAR NADMORSKI

This 1.5-kilometer paved seaside promenade stretches from the city center down towards the Redlowo district. With sweeping views of the bay, it is heavily frequented by locals and tourists alike for walking, jogging, cycling, and rollerblading, protected from the waves by a concrete breakwater.

14. GDYNIA FILM CENTRE

A striking piece of modern architecture that serves as the cultural hub for cinema lovers. It houses the Gdynia Film School, a studio cinema screening arthouse films, and a gallery. It is the primary venue for the annual Polish Film Festival, often referred to as the Polish Academy Awards.

15. MOTORIZATION MUSEUM

Tucked away in the Chylonia district, this unique private museum features a meticulously restored collection of vintage cars and motorcycles. Designed to look like a 1920s cobblestone street, the exhibits include rarities like the Ford Model T and classic Polish vehicles, making it a hidden gem for auto enthusiasts.